



***What an exciting time it is to be involved with Rossholme – and our active supporters increase daily.***

Anne Halliday, my cousin, who has been a long term supporter of Rossholme, reports on her first visit to Kenya:

## THE TRIP OF A LIFE TIME

*Back in June, my cousin, Mrs Judith Webb, and I went off to Kenya, on a two point trip. Needless to say one of those points was a safari, something that I'd wanted to do for a long time. It was a wonderful experience, to see all those animals in the wild, in their natural environment. It was unforgettable.*

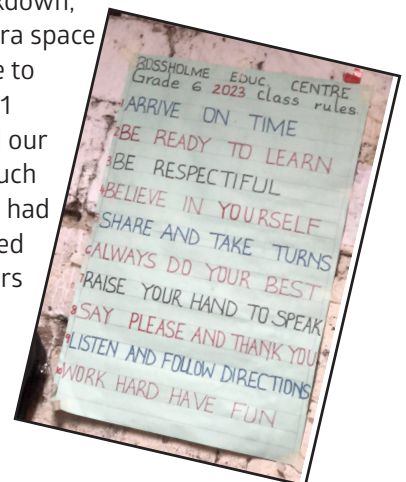
*Even though that formed the largest part of the trip, it was not the main reason we went.*

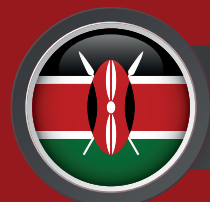
*The main reason was to visit Rossholme Kenya in the Kiambiu Slum of Nairobi. What an experience! 425 children ranging in age from 3 – 12, all smiling and so happy in their learning experiences. Their days were long, from 7 in the morning till 5 in the evening, well 3:15 for the little ones. They were all immaculately dressed in their yellow and navy school uniforms, shoes clean and hair tidy. Their working environment was cramped but they were all so happy, eager to show us their school and what they were working at. In the afternoon, before we left, the different classes put on a wonderful impromptu concert, some singing, some reciting and some dancing, all so confident in what they were doing and their English was perfect. They were a joy to be with and a credit to their wonderful hard-working teachers.*

*I just loved meeting them all. Thank you  
Anne Halliday*

Unfortunately, cheap flights and missed connections meant that we found ourselves in Addis Ababa, Ethiopia instead of Nairobi and so missed our first day's visit to the school but we made up for it the following day when an early car got us there by 7:30am. We were very warmly welcomed by Headteacher Joyce Aruga, her wonderful teaching staff, the cooks and the very cheerful pupils in their classrooms. These had been recently fitted out with solar panels to give lighting as well as purpose made locker desks, all thanks to the generous donations from East Africa Childrens Project (EACP), with whom we have established a very useful link.

This was my first visit to these premises which Joyce had managed to find at very short notice back in December 2019, just before Covid lockdown. They provided so much extra space meaning we were now able to accommodate 425 pupils, 11 teaching staff, 2 cooks and our valued security guard. A much more spacious central area had been resurfaced and enabled the children to play outdoors more easily, even if it was only one class at a time.





**ROSSHOLME  
KENYA**

# GOOD NEWS

Registered as a Charitable  
Incorporated Organisation  
(CIO), Charity No 1178553

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For further info please  
contact Judy Webb  
[judy@rossholmeinkenya.org](mailto:judy@rossholmeinkenya.org)

## FUNDRAISING

We are a registered charity  
(number 1178553) which  
means that Gift Aid can  
be claimed on donations  
made by UK tax payers.  
Donations can now be made  
through CAFDonate which  
can be accessed through our  
website:

[www.rossholmeinkenya.org](http://www.rossholmeinkenya.org)

CAFDonate will also  
process the GiftAid or,  
alternatively, if donations  
are made directly to the  
charity, a GiftAid form can  
be downloaded from the  
website and returned to:  
[judy@rossholmeinkenya.org](mailto:judy@rossholmeinkenya.org)  
25% Gift Aid makes a  
significant difference to  
the donations you  
are kind enough to  
make. Unfortunately,  
Amazon Smile have now  
discontinued their donations  
on every purchase made.

We aim to publish a  
Newsletter about every  
6 months so, if you know  
of anyone else who may  
be interested in receiving  
one by email, please let us  
know. In line with GDPR, we  
need permission for names  
to be on a mailing list but  
we assure you that it is not  
published anywhere; it is  
retained only by us and all  
emails are BCC'd so no list of  
emails is available.

**CAF**  
Charities Aid Foundation

*Fleximedia • 01278 722577  
is proud to support &  
donate their time to design  
the Rossholme in Kenya  
Newsletter*

The good news from Joyce was that the  
Landlord had decided to take retirement from  
the slum and had offered Joyce first refusal  
on the acquisition of the property and land  
which we are currently renting. All slum land  
in Kenya is Government owned so we would  
not be able to 'purchase' the land as such but  
it would certainly give us the best possible  
option. All our children are slum residents  
so this is where we need to be; acquisition of  
this land and property, even on these limited  
terms, would give us more security and enable  
us to develop the school.

It was therefore, in July that we launched  
a Project Campaign to raise KES4,500,000  
(c.£25,000 at current exchange rates) by the  
end of the year – quite an ambitious target  
but we have made good progress thus far and  
we are optimistic that our goal is achievable.

A letter was sent out to all our supporters  
explaining the situation and this has already  
resulted in some generous donations. A  
Rossholme Concert was held in the Appley  
Pavilion in Somerset on 30th September,  
featuring our local Village Festival Choir and  
other local performers as well as professional  
solo pianist, Richard Lennox (performing  
at a much-reduced special rate). Richard is  
himself from Weston super Mare and has a  
long association with the original Rossholme  
School in Somerset.

We are particularly grateful to the many local  
helpers and volunteers who helped us on the  
night and who contributed so generously.  
Facebook posts and other publicity combined  
with very generous support from the East  
Africa Childrens Project (EACP), have

enabled us to secure  
£15,290 to date.

**Steve Swan, who  
has been a great  
supporter for  
several years  
has written and  
published a book,  
especially for us, called  
Having a Larf. As Mike Parkinson writes:**  
"Steve has managed to create an extremely  
funny book from some very off-the-wall  
sketches which had everyone in stitches at  
the time (last year's Having a Larf Show for  
Rossholme). The themes and delivery in  
What's that About? (the second part of the  
book) are very relevant to today's world".  
It is available for a donation (min £10 please)  
from me, Judy Webb (in person or by email/  
post, adding £2.60:) [judy@rossholme.co.uk](mailto:judy@rossholme.co.uk)



## A ROUGH RAMBLE FOR ROSSHOLME

Last year Kitty Hollingsworth very kindly  
raised £820 for us by walking 26 miles across  
Dartmoor. With her nephew Christian, she's  
doing it again this year on Saturday 11th  
November. Donations  
can be made through our  
website, or by using this  
QR code:

*Thank you so much Kitty  
and Christian!*



**STOP PRESS: they've done it and, so far,  
have raised a fantastic £1220**



The opening of the first Kirsty's Place,  
a Day Care Centre within Kiambu for  
children too young to attend Rossholme

